THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. 'Money is external' implies that value of an object lies in: 1

(a) colour **(b)** price
(c) emotional attachment **(d)** size

2. The poem's emotional power depends on: 1

(a) rhyme only
(b) violent action
(c) simplicity of incident and depth of reflection
(d) long narrative

3. Which statement best captures the poem's moral? 1

(a) Never play near water **(b)** Grief is foolish
(c) Money can fix everything **(d)** Growth comes through bearing loss

4. The poem differs from a lament in that it: 1

(a) turns sorrow into insight **(b)** ignores grief
(c) is a dialogue **(d)** tells a comic story

5. The poem's universal quality arises from the: 1

(a) specific date **(b)** famous names
(c) generic 'boy' and common experience **(d)** unique setting

6. Which of the following is NOT a feature of the poem? 1

(a) a symbol of loss **(b)** a reflective ending
(c) a sympathetic observer **(d)** a comic tone

7. The phrase 'ultimate shaking grief' is used to show that: 1

(a) the boy's sorrow is complete and overwhelming
(b) the poet is angry
(c) the boy is acting
(d) the loss is trivial

8. The poet's silence at the end of the first part is: 1

(a) haste **(b)** fear
(c) an ethical stance of non-intrusion **(d)** laziness

9. The poem is a model for teaching: 1

(a) empathy and resilience **(b)** grammar only
(c) map reading **(d)** chemistry

10. The boy's silence can be read as: 1

(a) laziness **(b)** a mark of authentic grief
(c) joy **(d)** indifference

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Evaluate the claim that the poem is more about the poet than the boy. 2

12. What is the effect of ending without resolution? 2

13. How does the poem use the harbour to deepen meaning? 2

14. How does the poem use plain language to achieve depth? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. How does the poem employ understatement to convey deep emotion? 3

16. Discuss how the poem would change if narrated by the boy. 3

17. Replace 'sad' with three precise words and use one. 3

OR

Discuss the poet's choice of a boy rather than an adult as subject. 3

18. Evaluate the relevance of the poem for classroom discussions on emotional intelligence. 3

OR

Identify two stylistic devices in the poem and explain. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Discuss how the poem balances sympathy and detachment. 5

OR

Discuss whether the poet is right in not offering money. 5

20. Compare the attitude to loss in 'The Ball Poem', 'A Letter to God' and 'The Sermon at Benares'. 5

OR

Write a short story where a child learns an important lesson through loss. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND